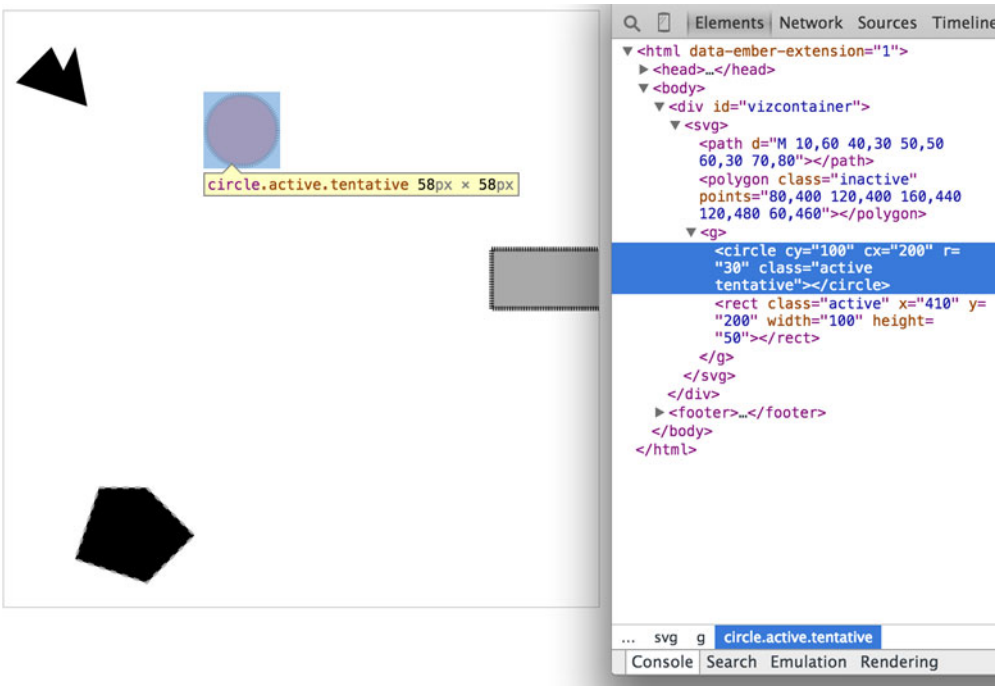


Figure 1.23 The SVG circle has its fill value set by its type in the style sheet, with its opacity set by its membership in the `.tentative` class and its stroke set by its membership in the `.active` class. Notice that the stroke settings from the `.tentative` class are overwritten by the stroke settings in the later declared `.active` class.

about other complex CSS selectors in more detail in a book devoted to that subject. For this book, we'll focus mostly on using CSS classes and IDs for selection and to change style. The most useful way to do this is to have CSS classes associated with particular stylistic changes and then change the class of an element. You can change the class of an element, which is an attribute of an element, by selecting and modifying the class attribute. The circle shown in figure 1.23 is affected by two overlapping classes: `.active` and `.tentative`.

In listing 1.5 we see a couple of possibly overlapping classes, with tentative, active, and inactive all applying different style changes to your shape (such as the highlighted circle in figure 1.23). When an element needs only be assigned to one of these classes, you can overwrite the class attribute entirely:

```
d3.select("circle").attr("class", "tentative");
```

The results, as shown in figure 1.24, are what we would expect. This overwrites the entire class attribute to the value you set. But elements can have multiple classes, and sometimes an element is both active and tentative or inactive and tentative, so let's